

Apex CRM — Sales Playbook (Internal Use Only)

Audience: Account Executives (AEs)

Purpose: Standardize how we qualify, position, and close deals while delivering a consistent buyer experience

1. Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Company Profile

- Segment: B2B companies (SaaS, services, light enterprise)
- Size: 20–300 employees (core sweet spot: 50–150)
- Revenue: \$5M–\$50M ARR
- Sales Motion: Multi-step sales cycles (not purely transactional)
- Tech Stack: Often using spreadsheets, legacy CRMs, or outgrowing tools like

HubSpot or Pipedrive

Buyer Personas

- VP of Sales / Head of Revenue (Primary buyer)
 - Sales Operations Leader (Champion / evaluator)
 - CEO / Founder (Economic buyer in smaller orgs)
-

Key Pain Signals

- CRM is too complex (e.g., Salesforce fatigue)
 - Lack of pipeline visibility or forecasting accuracy
 - Reps are not consistently using the CRM
 - Revenue operations are manual and fragmented
 - CRM costs are increasing faster than value delivered
-

Disqualification Signals

- <10 employees (too early)
 - No defined sales process
 - Purely transactional/high-volume low-touch sales
 - No urgency to change systems
-

2. Discovery Framework

Objective

Understand the current state, quantify pain, and create urgency tied to revenue outcomes.

Core Discovery Areas

A. Current System & Workflow

- “Walk me through your current sales process from lead to close.”
 - “Where does your CRM help—and where does it slow you down?”
-

B. Pain Identification

- “What’s the most frustrating part of managing your pipeline today?”
 - “How confident are you in your forecast right now?”
-

C. Impact Quantification

- “How does that impact revenue or missed opportunities?”
 - “What happens if this doesn’t improve in the next 6–12 months?”
-

D. Decision Process

- “Who else is involved in evaluating a new CRM?”
 - “What does a successful implementation look like for you?”
-

Key Insight to Extract

You are not selling a CRM—you are solving pipeline visibility, rep productivity, and revenue predictability.

3. Demo Flow (30–45 Minutes)

Guiding Principle

Demo outcomes, not features. Tie everything back to their pain.

Demo Structure

1. Set the Frame (3–5 min)

- Recap discovery insights
- Align on priorities

“I’ll focus on how Apex solves [pain #1] and [pain #2]—sound right?”

2. Pipeline Visibility (Core Differentiator)

- Show clean pipeline view
- Highlight deal tracking and stage clarity

- Emphasize real-time updates

Narrative:

“Your entire pipeline—accurate, up-to-date, and actionable.”

3. Workflow & Automation

- Show automated tasking, follow-ups, and deal progression
- Demonstrate how reps save time

Narrative:

“Reps spend more time selling, less time updating CRM.”

4. Forecasting & Reporting

- Show forecasting dashboard
- Highlight accuracy and simplicity

Narrative:

“Leadership gets clarity without needing a data analyst.”

5. Ease of Use

- Show how quickly reps can adopt
- Minimal clicks, intuitive UI

Narrative:

“No training overhead. Your team actually uses it.”

6. Close with Vision

- Paint future state

“This is what your team looks like 60 days after implementation.”

4. Common Objections & Responses

“We’re already using a CRM.”

Response:

“Most of our customers were in the same position. The question isn’t whether you have a CRM —it’s whether it’s actually helping your team close more deals.”

“Switching sounds painful.”

Response:

“That’s a valid concern. Apex is designed for fast onboarding—most teams are fully live in weeks, not months, with guided migration support.”

“It’s not in the budget right now.”

Response:

“Understood. Typically, teams justify Apex by improving close rates and rep productivity. If we could show a clear ROI, would that change the conversation?”

“We need something customizable.”

Response:

“Apex is configurable where it matters—without requiring developers or consultants like more complex systems.”

“We’re considering Salesforce / HubSpot”

Response:

“Both are strong platforms. Where Apex stands out is delivering the functionality teams actually use—without the complexity or cost overhead.”

5. Closing Techniques

1. The Future-State Close

“Based on what we’ve discussed, do you feel Apex gets you closer to the sales process you want?”

2. The Gap Close

- Reiterate current pain vs. future state

“Right now you’re dealing with [pain]. Apex eliminates that by [solution]. Is there anything holding you back from moving forward?”

3. The Timeline Close

“If we were to start this month, we could have your team fully onboarded within 4–6 weeks. Does that timeline align with your goals?”

4. The Champion Close

“From your perspective, does Apex feel like the right solution to bring internally?”

Deal Progression Checklist

- Pain clearly identified and quantified
 - Economic buyer engaged
 - Decision process defined
 - Timeline established
 - ROI aligned
-

6. Handoff to Customer Success (CS)

Objective

Ensure seamless transition from sales to onboarding with full context.

Handoff Requirements (Mandatory)

1. Deal Summary

- Customer goals and success criteria
 - Key pain points
 - Why they chose Apex
-

2. Stakeholder Map

- Economic buyer
 - Champion
 - End users
-

3. Implementation Expectations

- Timeline discussed during sales
 - Key integrations or data migration needs
-

4. Commercial Details

- Contract terms
- Pricing and package
- Renewal expectations

Internal Handoff Process

1. AE completes handoff form in CRM
2. Internal sync call with CS (15–30 min)
3. Intro email to customer (AE + CS)
4. CS schedules kickoff within 48 hours

Customer-Facing Transition Messaging

“Now that we’re moving forward, I’ll introduce you to our Customer Success team—they’ll ensure a smooth rollout and help you hit your goals quickly.”

Final Notes for AEs

Winning Behaviors

- Sell outcomes, not features
- Drive urgency through impact
- Control the process (don’t react to it)
- Always tie back to revenue

Core Philosophy

“Apex CRM wins when we simplify complexity, deliver fast value, and make the customer feel confident—not overwhelmed.”

End of Document — Internal Sales Use Only